THE SCD BULLETIN

Society of Capital Design · student newsletter

THIS ISSUE

Getting more from what you already own

THIS ISSUE TRAINS · THINKING IN COST PER USE

Money and markets

SpaceX went public on June 12, 2026 in the largest IPO in history, priced at USD 135 per share and valued near USD 1.77 trillion on its Nasdaq debut. Years of private guesses about its worth became one number set by the whole market in a single morning. What were investors actually buying? Not rockets, but the arithmetic behind them.

A rocket that flies once carries its whole construction cost on a single launch. A rocket that flies twenty times splits that cost twenty ways, so every flight after the first is close to pure margin. The most valuable companies are usually the ones that found a way to sell the same expensive thing more than once.

The SCD takeaway: investors were pricing the arithmetic of reuse, not the hardware. When valuing anything, find the number that repeats.

Sources: Fortune, June 11, 2026, fortune.com/2026/06/11/spacex-ipo-largest-history-wall-street-analysts-split-valuation-debate; CNBC, June 9, 2026, cnbc.com/2026/06/09/spacex-ipo-explained-stock-price-date

Engineering corner

A skyscraper sized rocket landed on a ship. In November 2025 Blue Origin's New Glenn flew its second mission, sent NASA's twin ESCAPADE probes toward Mars, then brought its giant first stage back to land upright on a platform at sea. Slowing that much falling mass takes one precisely timed engine burn. The hard part is not reaching space; it is getting the expensive part back in one piece.

The SCD takeaway: the prize was not reaching space; it was recovering the expensive part. Design for the second use.

Your move

The price of a thing matters less than its price divided by how often you use it. A 300 dirham calculator used daily for two years costs pennies per use; a 50 dirham gadget used twice cost 25 per use.

This week, on your own: take one thing you or your family bought this year and divide its price by its honest number of uses so far. Then decide what that number must reach for the purchase to have been right.